



Galaxy devices in NSA

The US National Security Agency has approved Samsung Galaxy devices to carry classified documents
<http://dgit.in/GalaxyNSA>



AMD slashes APUs

AMD fanboys will be delighted to know that AMD has slashed off the prices on its A-series APUs

Bazaar

Pentax K-500

Almost hits the sweet spot

The key features of Pentax K-500 include an APS-C (23.7x15.7mm) 16MP CMOS sensor, an ISO range of 100-51200, a 6fps drive motor, 11-point AF system, full HD 1080p video recording at 30, 25 and 24fps, HDR mode and shutter speeds ranging from 30 seconds to 1/6000. The viewfinder offers almost 100% frame coverage and there is also a 3-inch LCD display at the back.

The K500 has a heavy build and weighs more than most of the entry level DSLRs in the market. The body feels really strong even with the plastic construction. Weighing in at 590gms, it is higher than the Nikon D3300 and even the Canon 1200D. The controls, dials and buttons are nicely placed and you don't feel completely lost if you are coming from any other DSLR brand, although it does take time to get used to the controls. It is said to be built on the same blueprint as the K50, but due to its entry level specs it has no weather sealing feature.

There are three dials, including one for changing modes, and the other two control your aperture and shutter speeds. Of course you can also use these dials to scroll through the menus.

The back has a bright 3-inch LCD and a four-way pad to control your settings along with some usual set of buttons. The viewfinder is comfortable thanks to the rubber eyecup. On the right there is the SD card slot underneath a plastic door which has rubber lining on the inside. There is also a slot for remote shutter release underneath the card slot which is protected by a rubber flap. The left side has PC/video connectivity port, a switch to change to manual, AF-S and AF-C focus modes, a RAW mode button and a flash release button. Like all DSLRs there is a hot-shoe port on the top and a pop-up flash unit. At the bottom there is the battery chamber which can take the standard supplied 1050mAh rechargeable lithium battery or 4-AA batteries which is quite a unique feature.

The performance level of the K500 is pretty good. Picture quality, RAW and JPEG, is impressive and there is also a very useful feature where the camera allows you to save a RAW file even if you haven't set the camera to save RAW format. The camera can pull out the RAW image from the buffer system.

You do get two command dials which is not usually seen on entry-level DSLRs. This makes it easier and quicker to change settings. The auto-



Price
₹51,990

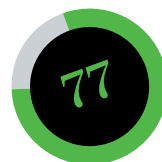
focus is fast but quite noisy on the kit lenses. The in and out movement of the lens is quite whirry, which is really annoying if you are shooting candid shots. Other than the noise there is another major issue that stumped us. The camera doesn't offer the auto-focus points in the viewfinder. However you can shift between the AF points if you have not set the camera to AF-A or auto point selection through the live view.

You do get a number of presets, filters and colour modes in the camera which will definitely keep the amateur photographer entertained. The interface, however, feels very outdated and reminding us of an old point shoot camera. We really hoped for a better and a more modern looking interface.

The image noise control on the K500 is quite impressive as pictures taken at ISO 3200 didn't show any signs of noise. At about ISO 6400-12800 you start seeing noise rising up. The focusing is pretty good and accurate, if we keep the 'no AF points in the viewfinder' issue out of the picture. The image stabilization works well and we felt it to be better than the Nikon D3200 and the Canon 1200D. The auto white balance is reliable in almost all situations, and we noticed that it gives cool results on some occasions.

The K500 is an impressive entry-level DSLR, but in a world where Canons and Nikons and Sonys are taking over the photography world, Pentax has lost ground. However if you don't plan to extend your photography kit and want to use a DSLR as a hobby photographer, the K500 is not a shabby choice at all.

Kunal Khullar



Feature	75
Performance.....	80
Value	85
Design	70

Specifications

APS-C (23.7x15.7mm)
16MP CMOS sensor; ISO
100-51200; 30 seconds to
1/6000 shutter speed; 6
fps drive motor; 11-point
AF system; Full HD 1080p
video recording at 30, 25 and
24fps; 3-inch LCD display

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